



HIV removed from human cell

Researchers from Temple University may have found a way to permanently delete HIV from the human cell <http://dgit.in/HIVDeleted>

Defender to the rescue

Defender is a bluetooth device with a camera and pepper spray which can be connected to your smartphone to alert authorities <http://dgit.in/DefenderDev>

Android smartphones

camera and messaging) and also adds the calendar app which shows you upcoming events. The good news is Asus has confirmed that the handset will get the new Android KitKat update. Thankfully, the UI is not very heavy and retains most of the basic stock features. It is quite colourful and gave us a fresh change from usual stock UI. Apps work smoothly and even multitasking is done efficiently thanks to the 2GB of RAM that it has. Day-to-day usage is fairly good and we didn't notice any app crashes or anything out of the ordinary. We were quite eager to test the raw capability of the hardware as we wanted to know what kind of performance level the Intel Atom SoC can deliver. The SoC proved to be better than all of the other smartphones that were tested in this comparison as the ZenFone 5 got the highest scores in all the benchmarks, battery test as well as specifications.

The Lava Iris X1 is powered by a 1.2GHz quad-core Broadcom processor with a Videocore GPU IV and 1GB of

WHAT MAKES A GOOD BUDGET SMARTPHONE?

So you have saved up enough money to go in for your first smartphone and if you're thinking of buying a smartphone within a budget then there are some points that you should consider before finalising on your device. Since we are talking about budget smartphones, there are some things that you might have to compromise on, but since the competition is getting stiff, the smartphones are getting better and much more affordable.

- **A good-quality display:** Smartphones in the entry level used to be limited to 3.5-4-inch devices, but now one can easily get one with a 5-inch display without having to pay a lot of money. Remember, size is not the only thing that matters, a good resolution is required so that everything looks crisp. Most of the smartphones today offer a minimum of 800x480 resolution but there are also some brands who have brought in 720p displays which is perfect for handheld devices. Another thing to consider is the quality of protective glass over the display, make sure it is strong and doesn't attract a lot of fingerprints.
- **Powerful SoC:** Gone are the days when cheap handsets meant compromising on the power of the hardware. An efficient processor, a good GPU and a substantial amount of RAM is a pre-requisite for any smartphone. A number of OEMs are selling quad-core equipped smartphones with one or even 2GB of RAM on board which not only provides a smooth experience but also improves on multitasking.
- **Avoid old version of OS:** A lot of affordable smartphones run on older software. So be it Android or Windows Phone, try to get a handset that is running on the latest OS update. If you go for a smartphone running on a very old update, there are chances that the device might not get future firmware and app updates. Updates keep your smartphone running smooth and efficient.
- **Good battery pack:** A good battery backup is important especially if you are planning to buy an Android device as it uses a lot of battery. Battery capacity is calculated in milliampere hours and somewhere around the 2000mAh mark should be excellent.
- **Camera:** A good camera has become a necessity and smartphones, even in the budget category, have decent, if not amazing camera modules. Look for a smartphone that offers good low-light capabilities and probably an LED flash to shoot in pitch dark conditions. Also, a smartphone with a front camera is advisable which is useful for making videos calls or the occasional selfie.
- **After sale service:** Invest in something that is offering a good and reliable after sale services. You don't want to invest in something that doesn't offer any support in case you damage your device.
- **Running costs:** While you do save some money on buying a budget smartphone, there are other costs that come into the picture. Remember that smartphones constantly utilise a lot of data, so make sure that you have a proper data plan or better a good Wi-Fi connection.

In the end, it is you who decides what kind of smartphone fits your needs. One might need a smartphone as a tool for communication, while one sees it as a source of entertainment, what your requirement be, do consider these points before you commit to a smartphone.



Sony Xperia E1 Dual

RAM. The performance on the smartphone is not very super slick and it just suffices for the price even after getting the latest Android 4.4 update. The UI is a bit sluggish and clearly the hardware doesn't provide enough power. Overall, the performance is decent and we really hoped that Lava would've used a better SoC and improved on the stability of the UI.

The Xolo Q1000 Opus runs on stock Android 4.2 with nothing special out of the box. The UI runs smooth and multitasking didn't show any hiccups. Xolo has added

its own anti-theft and battery management app which can be quite handy. For normal daily usage the smartphone is a good option if you want an affordable Android device. Gaming experience on the Q1000 Opus was surprisingly good. We played Real Racing 3 for some time and we were amazed to see the smartphone handle the heavy graphics well.

Running on a stripped down version of Sense UI on top of Android 4.2.2, the Desire 310 is powered by a 1.3GHz quad-core MediaTek processor with just 512MB of RAM. The UI is



Xolo Q1000 Opus